

Incident Commander

Typical assignment: General Manager / Acting General Manager. Primary function: overall strategic command and decision-making authority.

You report to

You hold command authority — you do not report upward during the incident. You notify Head Office and hand over only at formal handover or All Clear.

First 0-3 minutes

- ☐ Confirm nature and location of incident.
- ☐ Assume Incident Command.
- ☐ Protect life first.
- ☐ Activate the Incident Command Team (ICT) and Emergency Response Team (ERT).
- ☐ Establish the Command Post at a safe location.
- ☐ Appoint/confirm Operations Commander, Logistics Commander, Emergency Coordinator, Medic, Fire Marshal where applicable, and Responders.
- ☐ Declare emergency radio priority / restrict non-essential radio traffic.
- ☐ Confirm immediate hazards and casualties.

Next 3-10 minutes

- ☐ Establish incident objectives: life safety; incident stabilisation; protection of property/environment; recovery.
- ☐ Confirm guest and team-member accountability.
- ☐ Notify Head Office.
- ☐ Ensure appropriate external emergency services are contacted.
- ☐ Decide whether strategic/full-property evacuation is required.
- ☐ Confirm medical/medevac requirement where relevant.
- ☐ Ensure the Emergency Coordinator starts the incident timeline/log.

EVACUATION AUTHORITY

Full or strategic property evacuation is authorised by the Incident Commander. Immediate life-saving movement from an area of imminent danger may be initiated by any trained responder without waiting for IC authorisation.

EXTERNAL-CALL AUTHORITY

External agency contact is normally initiated by the IC, or by the Emergency Coordinator under IC instruction. In an immediate life-threatening emergency, a trained responder may contact medical, fire, police or other emergency services without delay if the IC or OC cannot be reached, and must notify the IC as soon as practicable.

Ongoing responsibilities

- ☐ Maintain strategic command.
- ☐ Receive situation reports from OC.
- ☐ Confirm resources through LC.
- ☐ Ensure EC maintains complete records.
- ☐ Coordinate with Head Office.
- ☐ Ensure external responders receive accurate information.
- ☐ Approve verified guest communications where appropriate.
- ☐ Refer media/public communications to Head Office.
- ☐ Review changing risks.
- ☐ Approve major operational decisions.
- ☐ Maintain command until formally handed over.

Do not

- ☐ Do not become absorbed in tactical scene work.
- ☐ Do not personally manage every responder.
- ☐ Do not speculate to guests or media.
- ☐ Do not compromise personal safety by entering an unsafe scene.

Before All Clear / handover

- ☐ Obtain confirmation from OC and relevant specialists/external responders.
- ☐ Confirm all persons accounted for.
- ☐ Confirm hazard controlled.
- ☐ Confirm treatment/evacuation complete.
- ☐ Declare All Clear.
- ☐ Lead debrief.
- ☐ Ensure EC completes reporting.

Forms & tools to grab

- ☐ A4-TZ or A4-KE Priority Contact Card
- ☐ Applicable scenario ICS Activation Checklist
- ☐ A14 Incident Report
- ☐ A15 SITREP where relevant
- ☐ A16 Crisis Communications Pack
- ☐ A34 Radio Code List

Remember

You hold single command authority until All Clear. Delegate the tactical scene to your OC and documentation to your EC — your job is the whole picture.